JASON (JONG MIN) JUNG

Department of Economics
University of Washington
Savery Hall
Seattle, WA 98195-3330
jmjung@uw.edu
jason-jongmin-jung.com

EDUCATION

2022–27 **University of Washington**, Seattle WA
Ph.D., Economics, expected 2027

2024 **University of Washington**, Seattle WA
M.A., Economics (concurrent)

2022 **Cornell University**, Ithaca NY
M.S., Applied Economics and Management

2020 **Boston University**, Boston MA
B.A., Economics, *Cum Laude*

2018 **Sciences Po**, Paris, France
Exchange Student, Economics

RESEARCH FIELDS

Health Economics, Applied Microeconomics, Economics of Fitness and Aging

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS AND AFFILIATIONS

2026 Research Assistant, National Bureau of Economic Research (NBER)

2026 Visiting Scholar, University of Ljubljana

2026 Adjunct Instructor, Seattle University

2025–26 Research Consultant, University of California, Berkeley

JOB MARKET PAPER

"Get Fit with MA? Estimating the Impact of Medicare Advantage on Physical Activity." *[Paper]*

Medicare Advantage (MA) plans increasingly offer supplemental fitness benefits, yet evidence on whether MA affects preventive health behavior among older adults is limited. Using nationally representative panel data from the Health and Retirement Study, we implement a difference-in-discontinuities design around the age-65 Medicare eligibility threshold, comparing changes in physical activity at Medicare entry between individuals who eventually enrolled in MA and those who enrolled in Traditional Medicare or non-Medicare enrollees. Crossing age 65 is associated with a 3.9 percentage point larger increase in the probability of daily vigorous exercise among MA enrollees, relative to a pre-65 mean of 3 percent. Event study estimates show no differential trends before age 65. The estimated differences are concentrated among women, non-White beneficiaries, and those without a college degree. These findings suggest that features of MA coverage may promote physical activity at least in the short run.

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

1. Ta R, **Jung JM**, Lee KE, Li J. "Associations between Use of Targeted Therapies, Hospitalizations and Emergency Department Visits Among Patients with Atopic Dermatitis: A Retrospective Cohort Study." *Journal of Managed*

Care and Specialty Pharmacy.
[Paper]

2. Chaparro P, **Jung JM**, Wallace J, Jones-Smith J, Baquero B, Knox M. "Factors Associated with Discontinued Participation in a Fruit and Vegetable Incentive Program in Seattle, Washington (United States): The Role of Community-Based Organizations in Engaging Non-English Speakers." *Preventive Medicine Reports*. 2026; 103567.
doi:10.1016/j.pmedr.2026.103567

WORKING PAPERS

1. **Jung JM**. "Move to Move? Neighborhood Fitness Culture and Exercise Among Older Adults."
   – Using longitudinal data on older adults who move, this study examines how changes in neighborhood fitness culture influence individual exercise behavior.

2. **Jung JM**, Li J, Soria C, Llibre-Guerra J, Liu M-M, Acosta D, Jiménez Velázquez I, Llibre-Rodriguez JJ, Dow WH. "Cross-national comparisons of older adult cognitive risk factors among Hispanics in the United States, Mexico, and the Caribbean."
   – Using cross-national data and Oaxaca–Blinder decomposition, this study examines how education and other risk factors account for cognitive differences among older Hispanics in the United States, Mexico, and the Caribbean.

3. **Jung JM**, Kim HM. "Light Physical Activity, Functional Reserve, and Nursing-Home Use among Older Medicare Beneficiaries."
   – This study examines associations between physical activity at different intensity levels, functional health, and nursing-home use among older Medicare adults in the United States.

4. **Jung JM**, Starc G, Jagrič T, Leskošek B, Martinko A, Sorić M, Došenović Bonča P, Jurak G. "Fitness and Childhood Obesity in Slovenia: Evidence from Municipal Data."
   – Using Slovenian municipal data, this study investigates geographic patterns in children's fitness and obesity and their relationships with local characteristics.

5. Jagrič T, **Jung JM**, Došenović Bonča P, Starc G, Leskošek B, Martinko A, Sorić M, Jurak G. "Fitness as National Capital: A Simulation Model of Fitness and Healthcare Costs."
   – This study develops a simulation framework to assess how population fitness may shape healthcare expenditures over time.

6. **Jung JM**, Basu A. "Do Unionized Firms Have Better Management Practices?"
   – This study investigates the relationship between firm unionization and management practices.

WORK IN PROGRESS

1. **Jung JM**, Li J, Dow WH. "Occupational Characteristics and Rural–Urban Disparities in Later-Life Cognitive Performance."
   – Using linked occupation and cognitive data, this project evaluates whether differences in job characteristics help explain rural–urban gaps in later-life cognition.

2. **Jung JM**, Rovniak L, Rosenberg D. "Where Seniors Sweat: Geographic Variation in SilverSneakers Uptake."
   – This project examines geographic disparities in the uptake of SilverSneakers fitness benefits among older adults.

PRESENTATIONS

Invited Presentations

1. 11th Workshop in Behavioral and Experimental Health Economics, University of Washington CHOICE Institute, Seattle, WA, 2026 (Scheduled)
2. UW Healthy Aging Forum, University of Washington School of Nursing, Seattle WA, 2026
3. Medicare Advantage Data Lab Seminar, Johns Hopkins University, 2025
4. Program in Health Economics and Outcomes Research Methodology, University of Washington CHOICE Institute, Seattle WA, 2025
5. Labor and Development Economics Brownbag, University of Washington, Seattle WA, 2025

Conference Presentations

2026 Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management Annual Fall Research Conference (APPAM), American Society of Health Economists Annual Conference (ASHEcon), Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting (SEA), AcademyHealth Annual Research Meeting, International Society of Behavioral Nutrition and Physical Activity Annual Meeting

2025 Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management Annual Fall Research Conference (APPAM)

Conference Service

2026 Session Chair & Organizer & Presenting Author, "Incentivizing Healthy Weight-Related Behavior," American Society of Health Economists Annual Conference (ASHEcon)

TEACHING

Course Instructor

ECON 2110: Principles of Microeconomics, Seattle University, 2026 *[Evaluation]*

ECON 200: Principles of Microeconomics, University of Washington, 2024–26 *[Evaluation]*

Teaching Assistant

ECON 200: Principles of Microeconomics, University of Washington, 2023–24 *[Evaluation]*

AEM 2300: International Trade and Finance, Cornell University, 2022

NBA 6540: Power and Politics in Organizations, Cornell University, 2021

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

2026 Graduate Student Conference Presentation Award, University of Washington

2022 James O. York Fellowship, University of Washington

REFERENCES

Melissa Knox
Department of Economics
University of Washington
knoxm@uw.edu

Jing Li
Department of Pharmacy
University of Washington
jli0321@uw.edu

William H. Dow
School of Public Health
University of California, Berkeley
wdow@berkeley.edu

Rachel Heath
Department of Economics
University of Washington
rmheath@uw.edu

Arnab Basu
Dyson School of Applied Economics and Management
Cornell University
ab362@cornell.edu

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Languages
Korean (Native), English (Fluent), German (Intermediate), French (Elementary)

Programming
Stata, R, LaTeX, Python (Elementary), MS Office